

# Understanding jQuery Mobile's Page Structure

This article delves into jQuery Mobile, an HTML5-based framework for creating mobile Web applications, which works on all popular smartphones and tablets. The authors enhance the discussion by walking the reader through how to develop a Web app.



jQuery Mobile is a cross-platform, open source UI framework that enables developers to build websites and applications by integrating HTML5, CSS3 and layout foundation with very little scripting. The framework is compatible with every mobile device and tablet (more platform support can be found at <http://jquerymobile.com/gbs/>) including browsers such as Firefox, Chrome, Internet Explorer, Android, BlackBerry and Symbian.

## What it is and what it is not

jQuery Mobile is built on top of jQuery, which means that it uses jQuery's core framework but doesn't replace it. Being lightweight makes it fast, robust and easily themeable - it allows us to build customised themes easily, and offers Ajax navigation with touch events, page transition, widgets and mouse navigation. jQuery Mobile is neither a SDK for packaging native Web apps, nor a framework for JavaScript, nor an alternative for Web browsers.

To get started, we need:

- A Web browser
- A text editor

## How to use jQuery Mobile

There are basically two ways we can make use of jQuery Mobile:

1. Simply download the latest stable version of the download builder from <http://jquerymobile.com/download-builder/>, extract the folder to your working directory and provide the path for use in your code.
2. Using CDN (Content Delivery Network) distributes often-used files across the Web and, most importantly, it doesn't require any download.

It is assumed that the reader is familiar with HTML5 markup language and the basics of CSS.

## jQuery Mobile's page structure

Create *index.html* and include jQuery Mobile library files in the header.

A page developed on jQuery Mobile must follow a series of rules for proper functioning. Every bit of content visible must be inside a container with the data-role attribute defined as *"page"* usually *div*.

First, declare the HTML5 doctype, viewpoint and width of the page inside the header. Viewpoint will ensure that your app appears correctly on all devices. Next, add the jQuery framework or library files either by downloading to the local folder or by loading files from CDN as shown in Figure 1.

## Create a page using a data attribute

Define a 'page' using the HTML5 data-role attribute with